

Westhampton Public Library Board of Trustees

Date: April 14, 2026

Time: 6:00pm

Community Room Westhampton Public Library

In-Person Meeting and Zoom

Present: Meaghan Schwelm, Anne Marie O'Reilly, Angela Griefen, Alison Thirkield, Rick Tracy, Jackie Brodeur

Absent: Deb Estelle

Call To Order: 6:03pm

Minutes from Last meeting: motion to approve by Angela Griefen, seconded by Jackie Brodeur.

Approved unanimously.

Treasurer's Report

Building: \$3,594.48

State Aid: \$9,621.85

Deferred Town Monies (expenses): \$19,888.85

Deferred Town Monies (salaries): \$21,675.70

Gifts: \$26,982.48

Director's Report

Statistics:

Children's Programs: 15 children's programs with 173 attending

Adult Programs: 22 adult programs with 92 attending

Teen Programs: 1 teen programs with 2 attending

General Audience Programs: 0 general audience programs with 0 attending

Circulation: 1,759 (March 2025 – 1,788)

eBooks: 566(March 2025 – 559)

Discussed that the current printer for book labels is consistently malfunctioning, and the labels it produces fade quickly. Discussed some options, including trying a different type of label, as well as research on replacement printers that other libraries find more reliable. The cost of a new printer would be \$400-\$700. Meaghan will continue to research and report back.

Meaghan brought up concerns about the roof, as it was not on the list of capital projects at the town budget informational sessions. The roof is 16 years old, has a history of leaks, and last repairs were in 2023, because of solar panel leaks. It was agreed it is important to plan for a new roof sooner than the 30 year mark. Meaghan will follow up with Doug about not seeing it on the list of town capital projects.

Meaghan nominated Margaret for MLS "Outstanding Library Support Staff" award, May 18, 2026.

Friends Report

Special guests to the Friends Meeting, Kelly O'Connor, Westhampton Teachers' Association and Jen Milikowski, Selectboard. Main focus was the override vote. October 4 is the date for 2026 Fall Festival. Outdoor Access Committee applied to AARP for grant for outdoor picnic area.

Old Business

Discussed current status of FY27 budget and possible impacts for the library going forward.

It was agreed to discuss updates to social media and meeting room policies next month.

New Business

- * Discussed when to close for Juneteenth; agreed to close the Thursday before, June 18.

- * Discussed current and proposed changes to the job description for Library Assistant position. Margaret does a lot that would fall under technical services, outside the description of assistant. Meghan suggested a better fit might be "Library Technician," to recognize the number of tasks and skills encompassed in her job. This will be discussed further.

- * Discussed information about some flexibility in which we meet MER (Materials Expenditure Requirement) in light of anticipated FY27 budget cuts.

- * Discussed library hours on the day of upcoming Town Meeting, May 9. It was agreed to open the day before, Friday, May 8, instead. This will be posted at the library, on the town website, and notice put on Facebook.

Any other Business to come before the Trustees, not anticipated at the time of posting of this agenda

Move to adjourn by Jackie Brodeur, seconded by Angela Griefen. Approved unanimously.

Meeting Adjourned: 7:10 pm.

Next Meeting: May 12, 2026, 7:00 pm.

Submitted By: Alison Thirkield